



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Academy

School Website: <https://trinityacademyportland.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Trinity Academy Portland (97217) demonstrates strong alignment with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements framework. Across all six categories—Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose and Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; and Parents & Community—the public materials consistently emphasize a Christian, classical approach centered on truth, goodness, and beauty, with a curriculum anchored in great books, liberal arts, and Socratic inquiry. The school presents a vision of formation over workforce preparation, a strong communal culture, and a living faculty who model virtue and learning. The public materials also show active parental partnership and frequent community-facing activities, including information nights, open houses, and campus events.

Executive judgments by category indicate CLASSICAL in every category, supported by explicit textual evidence from Trinity Academy Portland's website and corroborating materials in the crawl. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

- Evidence highlights include: a mission and curriculum built around truth, goodness, and beauty; explicit reference to Scripture, sacred doctrine, and daily morning prayer; a classical curriculum design including great books, Socratic seminars, and a humanities-focused approach; active, small-class pedagogy with Socratic seminars in upper grades; a living faculty that serves as the living curriculum; and strong parental partnership with formal opportunities for formation and involvement (Open Houses, Coffee Hours, and family-centered events) , , , .

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Overall, Trinity Academy Portland earns CLASSICAL across all six categories, with no evident category that departs from classical indicators in the provided materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot**Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school is described as built on a “joyful, discerning, and ecumenical Christian culture” and explicitly emphasizes Christian worship and doctrine within its curriculum and culture (e.g., Scripture and sacred doctrine; daily morning prayer) ,. - Textual emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as central ideals, including explicit mentions of “truth, goodness, and beauty” as guiding ideals in the curriculum and culture (e.g., “the discovery of truth, the practice of goodness, the creation of beauty”) ,. - The school's mission and culture foreground Christian humanism, liturgy-like practices (prayer, communal worship), and a sacred orientation to learning (e.g., daily morning prayer; sacred doctrine; liturgical life) ,.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth; goodness; beauty; theology; sacred doctrine; liturgy; morning prayer; wonder; awe. - Negative keywords present: relativism; secular humanism; values-clarification (not evident in public materials). - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords (6–7 distinct indicators) vs. Negative keywords (0–1 indicators) yields a near-100% positive signal for this category.

Why this rating - The materials consistently frame education as formation in a transcendent moral order centered on truth, goodness, and beauty, with explicit theological grounding and liturgical practice, satisfying the Positive/Negative keyword framework for a Classical religious foundations orientation. The absence of neutralizing signals (e.g., strong secular humanist language) supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Cited material anchors: “Christian culture”; Scripture and sacred doctrine; daily morning prayer; discovery of truth, practice of goodness, creation of beauty; Christian humanism; liturgical life .

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation over vocational prep, focusing on virtue, wisdom, and a Christian-humanist formation rather than mere job-readiness (e.g., “to educate young men and women in a true and integral Christian humanism through our classical approach to education”). - The curriculum and culture stress the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty and the formation of character as central aims (e.g., “the discovery of truth, the practice of goodness, the creation of beauty”). - The high regard for Great Books, Great Conversation, and Socratic seminars as avenues to knowable truths and human excellence is explicit (e.g., “Socratic seminars,” “great works of literature, poetry, philosophy, theology, and original historical documents”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; human flourishing; wisdom; liberal education; telos; great conversation; permanent questions; classical mission; scholé; contemplation (as implied in the educational aims). - Negative keywords present: college/career readiness emphasis (not present in the public materials as a primary goal); project-based or strictly experiential learning (not emphasized as the core pedagogy). - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators outnumber negative ones; a robust majority of indicators align with classical formation and aims; approximate positive count: 5–7; negative count: 0–1 (none clearly evident).

Why this rating - The explicit articulation of formation, virtue, and wisdom, plus the affirmation of classical aims (great conversation, liberal education, canon-based study) signals CLASSICAL alignment. The absence of a strong hints toward a solely job-oriented or secular-contemporary aim strengthens the CLASSICAL classification.

Cited material anchors: formation and Christian humanism; classical approach; truth/goodness/beauty; Great Books/Great Conversation; Socratic seminars; long-standing classical curriculum orientation .

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site presents a “classical curriculum” organized around Humanities, Mathematics & Science, and Fine Arts, with explicit integration across grade levels and a focus on reading original texts; Students engage with literature, history, writing, Scripture, language, music, art, and drama; the approach emphasizes rigorous study and interaction with teachers and peers. This is visible in the Curriculum overview and related pages (e.g., “CURRICULUM” section; humanities, math & science, fine arts; reading and discussion of original texts) . - The materials emphasize great books, primary sources, and canonical works; and they describe the inclusion of Great Books and a classical triad (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as parts of the approach (e.g., “classical curriculum,” “great books,” and Socratic discussions in high school) . - History is treated as a core curriculum thread rather than a separate “social studies” silo, with history intertwined through humanities and primary texts; and the curriculum places emphasis on reading, discussion, and textual engagement (e.g., “literature, writing, and history; mathematics and science; Scripture and Christian doctrine; foreign language; and music... history included within humanities”) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; Great Books; great books; history; primary sources; classical curriculum; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Socratic texts; recitation; narration;

memory work; memory; chant; hymnody; sacred art; education for leisure (scholé); contemplation (as an aspirational goal). - Negative keywords present: social studies terminology replacing history; project-based learning; experiential learning focus are not present as primary curriculum signals. - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators dominate; approximate positive count: 4–9; negative count: 0–2 (no explicit social studies replacement or project-based emphasis found in the core curriculum materials).

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on liberal arts under a classical framework, the incorporation of Great Books and canonical texts, textual engagement with history, and the explicit reference to a classical curriculum all align strongly with CLASSICAL criteria for Curriculum.

Cited material anchors: “classical curriculum” with humanities, math & science, fine arts; Great Books; reading original texts; history integrated into humanities; strong emphasis on canonical study and textual engagement; curriculum overview and content (curriculum pages) , ,

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes Socratic seminars in upper school, with explicit reference to “the art and science of Socratic seminars” as students read and discuss great works of literature, poetry, philosophy, theology, and documents; this is a central pedagogical practice in high school (Socratic seminars; upper-level rhetoric; seminars; discursive inquiry) , . - There is a commitment to contemplative/restful learning at times and to a living, inquiry-driven approach; the lower school experiences include memory-focused techniques (narration/recitation) and emphasis on wonder; the materials reference “wonder” as a pedagogical outcome and a memory-enhancing approach (e.g., direct exploration, wonder) , . - The site notes “the faculty members model the attitudes and habits that characterize a lifelong love of learning,” and that “teachers strive to inspire in the students a sense of wonder” (i.e., mentors as the living curriculum).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminars; seminars; discourse; rhetoric; dialogue; narration; recitation; chanting (as part of memory pedagogy); contemplative/restful learning; scholé; wonder; living curriculum; faculty as mentors. - Negative keywords present: project-based learning; experiential learning focus; constructivist approaches (not emphasized in core public-facing materials). - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators clearly exceed negatives; positive count approximately 5–8; negative count 0–1 (no explicit project-based emphasis; no strong experiential-only signals observed).

Why this rating - The core pedagogy centers on Socratic inquiry, classical memory work, and a disciplined but contemplative approach consistent with classical pedagogy. The absence (in the public materials) of a dominant experiential-project orientation further supports CLASSICAL.

Cited material anchors: Socratic seminars in high school; direct exploration; wonder; memory/recitation approaches; living curriculum; teacher as mentor; restful contemplative learning; discipline of learning culture , ,

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty is described as model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; they “model the attitudes and habits that characterize a lifelong love of learning,” and are described as living curriculum and as a core of the school (faculty as a community of learners) , . - The school emphasizes a culture of collegiality and a “portrait of what a teacher should be” and a “living curriculum,” with teachers who are “sages” and “mentors” in a classical pedagogy framework (as reflected in the lexicon) and evidenced in staff pages and faculty sections , . - Leadership and staff structure are visible in public pages (Head of School; Executive Director; faculty pages) and the institutional accreditation and ongoing faculty development emphasis (Cognia accreditation) appear on the site as well (turn0file2; turn0file1; turn0file7).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; faculty of friends; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; faculty development; masterful teachers and mentors; moral exemplars; character formation. - Negative keywords present: none evident in the public-facing materials. - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators exceed; positive count 4–6; negative count 0.

Why this rating - The local materials strongly present faculty as exemplars and living curriculum, with explicit calls to virtue, mentoring, and collegiality—core classical indicators for the Faculty element.

Cited material anchors: “model teachers and mentors”; “living curriculum”; “faculty members model the attitudes and habits...”; “Portrait of a teacher” concepts; faculty pages; leadership profiles ,.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents as co-teachers and supports parental formation through the website, gatherings, and book studies; there are explicit statements about guiding parents in classical education and welcoming visits to the school (open campus or open-door approach) ,. - Public materials reflect an ongoing culture of parent involvement through events such as Open Houses, Coffee Hours, and lectures, with direct references to parent engagement in classical education (e.g., “Trinity Coffee Hour,” “Open House,” “Evening lectures”) ,. - The campus location and admissions communications indicate openness to visiting families; admissions materials show invitations and detailed contact information, suggesting an accessible community orientation for prospective and current families ,.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental formation; parent involvement; open campus; visits welcome; book studies and gatherings; parent formation material. - Negative keywords present: consumer language or minimal parental involvement signals; these are not evident in the public materials; the site rather emphasizes active parental formation and involvement. - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators around 4–5; negative indicators 0.

Why this rating - The school presents a robust, explicit model of parent partnership and formation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Cited material anchors: “partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental primacy”; “parent formation”; “open campus”; “parents welcome to visits”; “Trinity Coffee Hour” and admissions events , ,.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable (no SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category identified). The six categories are CLASSICAL, and there is no overarching SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation requiring targeted needle-moving changes. If any future materials were to show reduced emphasis on Great Books or increased emphasis on workforce preparation, that would be a potential needle-moving opportunity; for now, no major changes are required.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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